NIKUNJ DAS KASAT

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EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University, Heinz College — Pittsburgh, PA
Master of Information Systems Management — Aug 2026 - Dec 2027 (expected)
Coursework: Machine Learning in Production, Intermediate Database Management, Python for Software Development

Ramaiah Institute of Technology — Bengaluru, India
Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science and Engineering; First Class with Distinction — Aug 2018 - Jul 2022
Coursework: Data Structures, Algorithms, Object Oriented Programming, Operating Systems, Multi Core Programming

WORK EXPERIENCE

Morgan Stanley — Bengaluru, India
Senior Technology Associate (Software Engineer II) — Feb 2023 - May 2026
- Designed a central FastAPI gateway exposing 40+ internal team functions as REST APIs with JWT-based role access control, piloted with 3 consuming teams serving ~15K requests/day, replacing one-off, per-team integrations
- Added Redis caching to high-traffic read endpoints, cutting p95 latency from ~800 ms to ~120 ms; led design reviews and rollout
- Cut a weekly report's runtime from 2+ hours to under 5 minutes by adding targeted indexes, rewriting join-heavy SQL, and parallelizing batch jobs with Python multiprocessing

Technology Associate (Software Engineer I) — Aug 2022 - Jan 2023
- Replaced a manual daily data reliability review with scheduled PowerShell checks and failure alerts, saving ~5 hours/week

Spring Analyst (Software Engineering Intern) — Feb 2022 - Jul 2022
- Automated Varonis file server onboarding in PowerShell, reducing per-server onboarding from ~3 hours to under 15 minutes

E Drives (early-stage EV rental startup) — Bengaluru, India
Software Developer Intern — May 2020 - Jan 2022
- Led a team of 7 interns as first engineering hire, running technical interviews and final hiring calls, and shipping Node.js and MongoDB payment and booking APIs on AWS
- Launched the Flutter rental app (Firebase auth, deep links, Google Maps), moving ~70% of bookings online; 1,000+ downloads

PROJECTS

Real-Time Movie Recommender, CMU 17-645 | *Python, Flask, Kafka, Docker, nginx, Prometheus* — Sep - Nov 2026
- Own serving and deployment for a simulated 1M-user platform: ~580K requests/day on one VM, 107 ms p95, 99.7% uptime
- Built zero-downtime blue/green deploys and a promotion gate that blocked a retrained model scoring 63% lower offline
- Traced a silent drop in personalization (68% to 35% at peak while 99.96% of requests returned 200) to rate limits on a user API, then built a profile snapshot store that cut p95 to 11 ms and raised personalized share to 71% in staging
- Built SLO monitoring with phone paging, and a read-only LLM on-call agent (8 of 9 held-out incident questions right)

call-me-maybe, HackCMU 2026 | *Python, FastAPI, MongoDB Atlas, Grok API* — Sep 2026
- Built the FastAPI backend for an AI agent that makes phone calls for users and hands off to a human only for decisions
- Designed a fail-closed, two-tier LLM policy gate that scored 97.5% accuracy with 0 false allows and 267 ms p50 latency on a 40-turn labeled eval; deployed on Vultr with TLS

freeCodeCamp Mobile App, Open Source Maintainer | *Flutter, Dart, GitHub Actions* — 2022
- Built the original Flutter app, later adopted as freeCodeCamp's official mobile app, now at 500,000+ Google Play downloads
- Reviewed community pull requests, owned release branches, and maintained CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions

LLM Features for Zulip, CMU Coursework | *Python, Django, TypeScript, memcached, Gemini API* — Sep 2026
- Extended Zulip, a mature open-source Django and TypeScript chat platform, with an unread-message recap and topic-drift detection; prevented hallucinated citations by validating every model-cited message ID against the source set

SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, Dart, PowerShell
Backend and Frameworks: FastAPI, Flask, Node.js, Express.js, REST APIs, Microservices, Distributed Systems, Concurrency, Flutter
Data: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MSSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Kafka, Firebase, pandas
Cloud and DevOps: AWS (EC2, S3), Docker, Kubernetes, nginx, Prometheus, Grafana, Linux, Git, GitHub Actions, pytest
AI Engineering: Grok API, Gemini API, OpenAI SDK, Prompt Engineering, LLM Evaluation

AWARDS AND CERTIFICATIONS

GIAC Cloud Security Essentials (GCLD), 2025: Scored 91%; cloud security across AWS, Azure, and GCP (IAM, encryption, compliance)
Hackathons: Winner, Smart India Hackathon 2022 (~160,000 participants) | 1st Place, Unisys Cloud 20/20 (edge AI attendance)